Carlos Santisteban

Software Engineer

Full-stack web development · User-facing features & UX

Berlin, Germany · EU citizen · Available immediately

View my portfolio
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Software engineer with 8+ years of experience building user-facing products end to end, from interface to API and data, focused on interfaces where functionality and ease of use matter as much as visual polish. Adept at using AI for research, planning, implementation, testing, verification and monitoring, and at building AI features into apps, while bringing the architecture direction and usability judgment AI still lacks.

EXPERIENCE

Independent Product Development
Apr 2025 – Present

Berlin

- Build and ship complete applications across platforms: offline-first web apps and PWAs, real-time multi-user apps with WebSockets and optimistic updates, desktop apps with Tauri, and cross-platform apps with React Native (Expo), backed by Node.js and Python APIs, SQLite and Cloudflare. Details in my portfolio.
- AI-assisted from 2025, fully agent-driven since 2026: research options, settle behavior and architecture in structured decision sessions, prototype, build in test-driven slices, and review UX, correctness and code quality before shipping.

Software Engineer
Jun 2021 – Mar 2025

Lingoda · Berlin

- Developed and maintained student-facing features of the language-learning platform in React, TypeScript and GraphQL, working with product, design and backend from planning through testing and release.
- On the post-class practice feature (AI-generated exercises reviewed by language experts), owned the quiz, flashcard, matching and dialogue interfaces and their session flow, scoring, retries, hints and progress.

Software Engineer
Sep 2017 – Feb 2021

Quandoo · Berlin

- Built the restaurant discovery and booking portal in React and Redux: campaign pages, widgets, search filters, server-side rendering and SEO.
- Led the investigation into upgrading the portal from React Router v3 to v5, since the old router was blocking other dependency upgrades, and built a working proof of concept in a mixed legacy and modern codebase. Also wrote SQL queries to answer product questions.

Software Development
Mar 2016 – Jul 2016

Market Logic Software · Berlin

- Built React UI components, D3.js data visualizations and dynamic widgets.

Software Developer
Apr 2015 – Jun 2015

AISA · San Luis Potosí, Mexico

- Built C# / WPF forms for government document-management software over SQL.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Frontend

React, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, React Native (Expo) · Redux, Zustand, TanStack Query, Apollo / GraphQL · Tailwind CSS, design systems · responsive UI, PWAs, SSR

Backend and data

Node.js (Hono, Express), Python, REST APIs / OpenAPI, WebSockets · SQL, PostgreSQL, SQLite, Cloudflare D1, Durable Objects, Supabase

Quality and delivery

Vitest, Playwright, property-based and end-to-end tests · Docker, GitHub Actions CI, Git, monorepos · Sentry, Datadog

AI

Claude Code, Codex, T3 Code · spec-first, testing and review workflows, custom skills · LLM features (Vercel AI SDK, OpenAI)

EDUCATION

Bachelor of IT Engineering

Tecnológico de Monterrey
2012 – 2017

Coursework: OOP, data structures, databases, networks, operating systems, IT security, cloud computing

LANGUAGES

Spanish Native
English Fluent
German Intermediate (B1–B2)